

**DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE / INFORMATION
TECHNOLOGY**

CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT TEST (CAT) 1

**TOPIC: SOFTWARE INSTALLATION & USER ACCOUNT
MANAGEMENT**

TIME: 1 HOUR 30 MINUTES

TOTAL MARKS: 50 MARKS

1. Distinguish between **System Software** and **Application Software**, giving two examples of each. *(6 marks)*
2. Outline **four** common methods or techniques an IT technician can use to collect software user needs within an organization. *(4 marks)*
3. State **four** critical factors (excluding hardware compatibility) that an organization must consider before selecting or purchasing software. *(4 marks)*
4. Briefly explain **two** advantages and **two** disadvantages of purchasing *Off-the-Shelf* (commercial) software compared to developing *Bespoke* (custom) software. *(4 marks)*
5. Name **four** settings or parameters that can be modified when configuring or managing a local user account profile (e.g., password policies). *(4 marks)*
6. Explain the technical differences between an **Administrator Account**, a **Standard User Account**, and a **Guest Account** regarding system privileges. *(6 marks)*

7. A growing accounting firm wants to transition from using manual ledger books to digital accounting software.
- a) Describe the step-by-step process the IT department should follow to ensure they select software that aligns perfectly with the accountants' day-to-day operations. *(8 marks)*
 - b) Discuss **two** acquisition methods available to this firm, highlighting a scenario where one method would be preferred over the other. *(4 marks)*
8. An office computer running Windows or Linux is shared by a Senior IT Administrator, a permanent Receptionist, and various visiting clients/interns.
- a) Recommend the most appropriate type of local user account for each of the three entities listed above, justifying your choices based on system security and operational needs. *(6 marks)*
 - b) Explain the security risks associated with failing to configure separate user accounts on a shared workstation. *(4 marks)*